

The Problem With Scaling Scribes

You're spending \$500K/year to cover 8% of your providers. Here's why that math never gets better.

Scribe programs scale linearly

Double the coverage = double the cost. There are no economies of scale.



To cover all 200 providers, you'd need 134 scribes at a cost of \$6.7M/year—an additional \$6.2M.

The costs you're not seeing

Beyond salaries, scribe programs carry hidden operational costs

Turnover & Training
~40% annual turnover rate

\$20K

You'll replace ~4 scribes this year at ~\$5K each in training costs

Management Overhead
~15% of program cost

\$75K

Scheduling, supervision, quality assurance, and administrative support

YOUR TRUE ANNUAL COST

\$595K

\$500K salaries + \$95K hidden costs

PER COVERED PROVIDER

\$40K/year

What if documentation support didn't scale this way?

AI-powered ambient documentation can support every provider without the linear cost curve. No turnover. No training. No coverage gaps.

Your Scribe Program Summary

Annual Investment

\$500K

Coverage

8%

Hidden Costs

+\$95K

Cost to Scale

\$6.2M

Bottom line: Your scribe program costs **\$40K/provider/year** when you include hidden costs. Scaling to 100% coverage would require an additional **\$6.2M/year**.

Key Takeaways

- Your scribe investment covers 8% of providers at \$40K per covered provider (including hidden costs)
- 185 providers (92%) document without support—74,000 hours annually
- Hidden costs (turnover, training, management) add ~19% to your visible program cost
- Scaling to full coverage would require \$6.2M additional—a 13x increase
- Linear scaling means no efficiency gains at scale—each new provider costs the same as the first

Ready to explore alternatives?

AI-powered ambient documentation can provide 100% coverage without the linear cost curve. Visit abridge.com to learn how.

Methodology & Assumptions

YOUR INPUTS

- 10 scribes at \$25/hr × 40 hrs/week
- 15 of 200 providers covered
- 400,000 annual encounters
- Scribe:Provider ratio 1:1.5

INDUSTRY ASSUMPTIONS

- ~40% annual scribe turnover rate
- ~\$5,000 training cost per new scribe
- ~15% management overhead
- Doc time without scribe: 12 min/encounter